Glucose Gel

Mechanism of action

- Glucose gel provides a source of glucose that can be easily swallowed and is rapidly absorbed.

Authorised practice levels

- All personnel. ATP is not required to administer glucose gel.
- First Responders: refer to 'diabetic emergencies' in the FR Field Guide.

Indications

- ✓ Hypoglycaemia in adults and children provided the patient is conscious enough to be able to swallow safely.
- ✓ Hypoglycaemia in neonates.

Contraindications

- ✕ None.

Cautions

- ⚠ None.

Use in pregnancy or when breastfeeding

- Safe and should be administered if indicated.

Dosage

- 10-20 g for all ages.
- Administer one sachet and repeat every ten minutes if hypoglycaemia persists or recurs.

Administration

- Administer PO.

Glucose Gel

- Glucose gel may be spread on the gums, tongue and inside of the cheeks of a baby or small child.

Common adverse effects

- None.

Usual onset of effect

- 5-10 minutes.

Usual duration of effect

- 30-60 minutes.

Usual preparation

- There are multiple different brands.
- Most are a sachet containing 10-20 g glucose.

Pharmacokinetics

- Glucose is absorbed in the stomach and small intestine.
- Glucose is rapidly metabolised by cells.

Common interactions

- None.

Additional information

- Document the approximate number of grams of oral glucose administered.